IntQRac

A CANADIAN PAYMENTS CONCEPT

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Scan an address.
Send with confidence.

A proposed interoperable QR layer for ordinary Interac e-Transfer recipient aliases.

The opportunity

Reduce first-time and one-off e-Transfer friction by making the recipient address machine-readable inside the banking app - while keeping the existing e-Transfer rail, Autodeposit resolution and familiar review/send experience.

Scope:

- Existing Canadian payment landscape
- Proposed QR standard and user journey
- Security and trust model
- Functional prototype and validation plan

Product thesis

No new payment rail. No new account infrastructure. Make the existing e-Transfer recipient address scannable.

Independent product concept | 26 October 2026
Not commissioned by or affiliated with Interac or any Canadian financial institution.

01 / EXECUTIVE VIEW

One interaction layer, three product principles

A focused concept for improving recipient discovery in ordinary e-Transfer - not a proposal to redesign Canada's payment infrastructure.

1. Solve a narrow friction point

The strongest use case is a first-time, one-off or in-person payment where the payer does not already have the recipient saved. QR adds little value for frequent repeat payments to existing contacts.

2. Reuse infrastructure that already works

Email/mobile aliases, Autodeposit, recipient verification, bank authentication and the e-Transfer send flow already exist. IntQRac proposes changing how the recipient address is supplied - not how money moves.

3. Keep trust with the bank, not the QR

The QR provides an address. The banking experience resolves the Autodeposit recipient and displays the verified name before the sender confirms payment.

Product principles

- **Evidence before expansion:** acknowledge Business Request Money and define the remaining gap.
- **Channel neutrality**: scanned, typed and saved recipients should enter the same underlying e-Transfer flow.
- **Minimum viable standard:** solve recipient capture before adding merchant callbacks, reconciliation or new rails.

Primary evidence: Interac e-Transfer send/Autodeposit guidance, Interac Business Request Money documentation, and the functional IntQRac prototype.

02 / CURRENT CANADIAN LANDSCAPE

Adjacent solution, distinct gap

Interac already supports Business Request Money, with QR available as one initiation channel. IntQRac does not attempt to replace that product; it explores a lighter interaction within ordinary e-Transfer.

Dimension	Business Request Money	IntQRac concept
Core object	Business payment/request	Existing e-Transfer alias
Logical initiator	Business / payee request	Payer initiates Send Money
Primary user	Enabled business/organization	Individual or business
QR role	Starts payment/request experience	Supplies recipient address
Special enablement	Through participating FI	Conceptually none beyond e-Transfer + Autodeposit
Reconciliation	Purpose-built capabilities	Ordinary e-Transfer level
Personal reusable QR	Not primary use case	Core use case

How research changed the concept

Initial hypothesis. A QR interaction could make Interac payments easier for individuals and businesses without a new UPI-like rail.

Discovery. Interac already offers QR-enabled collection as part of Business Request Money.

Refinement. IntQRac was narrowed to ordinary e-Transfer aliases, with primary focus on individuals, one-time payees, in-person payments and lightweight acceptance.

03 / PROPOSED MODEL

One alias, one scan, existing rails

The proposed change is deliberately small: introduce a common QR representation of an existing e-Transfer alias and a Scan QR entry point inside participating banking apps.

A SIMPLE SCAN-TO-SEND FLOW

• 1	• 2	• 3
Scan	**Resolve**	**Send**
QR inside e-Transfer	Autodeposit recipient	Existing review flow

Static QR

Reusable for personal and lightweight acceptance. The payer supplies the amount.

```
ietqr://pay?v=1&type=email&to=john@example.com
```

Pre-filled QR

The same schema can optionally carry amount, message and reference. These remain reviewable/editable in V1 because the QR is payment instruction, not authenticated authority.

```
ietqr://pay?v=1&type=email&to=payments@coffee.ca&am=18.75&cu=CAD&msg=Order%201284&ref=ORD1284
```

Proposed V1 fields

Field	Requirement	Purpose
v	Required	Protocol version
type	Required	email or phone
to	Required	Recipient alias
am	Optional	Amount
cu	Optional	CAD in V1
msg / ref	Optional	Message / reference

04 / TRUST AND SECURITY

The QR carries an address, not identity

A scanned alias is input. The verified Autodeposit recipient shown by the banking experience is the trust signal the payer must confirm.

TRUST BOUNDARY

• 1	• 2	• 3
QR	**Resolve**	**Authorize**
Recipient alias	Verified name	Sender confirms

Security and product guardrails

Risk / decision	V1 handling	Product rationale
QR replacement	Show independently resolved Autodeposit name	Do not trust printed identity
Fake recipient name	Name excluded as authoritative QR data	One source of identity truth
Non-Autodeposit recipient	Out of scope in V1	Avoid security-question branch
Modified amount	Require review; keep editable	QR is instruction, not authority
Malformed / future QR	Strict validation; fail closed	Protect interoperability
Sensitive data	Alias + optional payment details only	No bank/account credentials in QR

Channel-neutral economics

A scanned alias, typed alias and saved contact are three ways of supplying the same recipient to the same underlying e-Transfer flow. IntQRac therefore does not propose a new fee merely because QR was used; existing account/e-Transfer pricing would continue to apply.

05 / FUNCTIONAL PROTOTYPE

From QR pixels to a simulated send flow

The prototype tests whether the proposal can be experienced end-to-end without pretending to connect to Interac or real financial institutions.

Core journey

• 1	• 2	• 3
Generate / receive QR	**Decode + validate**	**Resolve + send**
Actual encoded URI	Camera, photo or sample	Mock Autodeposit + bank flow

What is genuinely functional

- QR generation from the proposed schema.
- Camera scan and QR image upload using the same decoder.
- Strict parsing and validation of supported fields.
- Mock Autodeposit resolution with verified-name presentation.
- Bank-style amount, review and simulated send experience.
- Developer/flow inspector showing logical request-response steps.

Single-phone usability

A user can generate a QR, save it to Photos, open the demo bank, choose the saved image, decode it, and complete the simulated transfer. Camera scanning remains available when the QR is shown on another device.

Prototype boundary

Frontend-only simulation. No real Interac API, bank account, settlement, merchant callback or money movement is used. The mock service layer exists to demonstrate the logical interaction, not to claim undocumented production APIs.

06 / PRODUCT FIT AND TRADE-OFFS

Strongest where the recipient is not already known

IntQRac is not intended to improve every e-Transfer. Its value concentrates in recipient-present and one-off scenarios.

High-fit scenarios

Scenario	Why QR helps
First-time / one-off payment	Avoid exchanging and manually typing an alias
In-person payment	Recipient can present a machine-readable address
Marketplace / casual seller	Useful without turning every payee into a saved contact
Freelancer / contractor / tutor	Reusable personal or business-facing QR
Small business already taking e-Transfer	Replace displayed email address with scan-to-send

Where existing solutions are better

- **Saved contacts:** faster for frequent repeat payments.
- **Business Request Money:** stronger when the business needs formal requests, integrated checkout, confirmation and reconciliation.
- **Card acceptance:** appropriate where card-network protections, rewards or merchant acquiring are required.

Adoption hypothesis

Could embedding Scan QR directly inside ordinary e-Transfer extend QR-payment convenience to individuals and businesses that do not need a full business payment-request product? This remains a hypothesis to validate - not a claim of market demand.

07 / VALIDATION AND NEXT STEPS

Validate the interaction before expanding the infrastructure

The next step is product discovery and a controlled pilot, not additional protocol complexity.

What I would test next

Audience	Key questions
Consumers	Is Scan QR easier than adding a one-time recipient? Is the verified Autodeposit name understood as the trust signal?
Small business	Would businesses already taking e-Transfer display a reusable QR? When does reconciliation make Business Request Money preferable?
Financial institutions	Can existing recipient resolution be reused? What fraud/monitoring changes would an in-app scanner introduce?
Interac / ecosystem	Who should own the schema? How should versioning and future request-backed QR formats coexist?

Pilot success measures

- Time to complete first payment
- Payment abandonment
- Successful recipient verification
- QR scan failure rate
- User confidence before sending

Roadmap

V1 - Scan-to-e-Transfer: email/mobile alias, Autodeposit only, payer-entered amount.

V1.1 - Pre-filled QR: amount, message and reference using the same schema.

V2 - Authenticated instruction: only if research shows a need for expiry, request IDs or stronger transaction guarantees - without duplicating Business Request Money.

Sources and evidence

- Interac - How to send money with Interac e-Transfer
- Interac - Business Request Money
- IntQRac prototype

Method: public documentation and the functional prototype reviewed October 2026. No access to private bank/Interac APIs, internal fraud models, commercial agreements or transaction adoption data. Recommendations are product hypotheses requiring validation.

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